

Unscripted

Product Requirements Document

One topic. One minute. No script.

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Status	Live — deployed at https://unscripted-phi.vercel.app/
Version	1.0
Last Updated	April 2026
Platform	Web, desktop-first but mobile-responsive

1. Overview

Unscripted is a web-based public speaking practice tool that helps users build confidence and self-awareness in their speech. Users receive a random topic, speak about it for one minute, and then review an AI-generated transcription that highlights filler words and repeated phrases. The goal is not just to practice more, but to practice with clearer feedback.

The live product is accessible at: <https://unscripted-phi.vercel.app/>

2. Problem Statement

Public speaking is one of the most common personal challenges, but most practice tools are vague. People may rehearse often, yet still not know what specifically hurts their delivery.

Unscripted addresses that gap by making speech patterns visible. Instead of only measuring that a user practiced, it shows where they overuse filler words or repeat phrases. That creates a clearer path to improvement.

3. Target Users

Unscripted is designed for people who want a lightweight way to improve speaking confidence and clarity.

It is especially useful for:

- Students preparing for presentations, interviews, or class discussions
- Young professionals improving workplace communication
- Anyone who wants to reduce filler words and speak more deliberately

The core user trait is intentionality. They are not just trying to speak more, they want to improve with direction.

4. Goals

Product Goals

- Provide a frictionless one-minute speaking challenge that can be completed in under 5 minutes end to end
- Surface specific, actionable feedback through filler word and repeated phrase detection
- Keep the experience self-directed, with no need for a coach, account, or other people

Non-Goals for v1.0

- Real-time feedback during speech
- Community or social features
- Native mobile apps
- User accounts or progress tracking
- Long-term analytics or session history

The core flow is Spin → Record → Transcribe → Reflect.

5.1 Topic Selection

- Users land on a home screen with a set of speaking categories
- They can optionally filter by category before spinning
- A random topic is selected from the chosen category
- After a topic is shown, users choose between Timer Mode and Record Mode

Current categories in the app:

- All Topics
- Personal
- Opinion
- Story Telling
- Professional
- Abstract
- Random

5.2 Timer Mode

- A 1-minute countdown timer for users who want to practice without recording
- The selected topic stays visible at the top of the screen
- No transcription is produced
- The mode is intentionally low pressure

5.3 Record Mode

- Users record speech through their browser microphone for up to 1 minute

- A countdown runs alongside the recording
- Recording stops automatically when time runs out, or manually if the user stops early
- After recording, users can listen back before moving to transcription

5.4 AI Transcription & Analysis (Core Feature)

- The audio is sent to OpenAI Whisper for transcription in English
- Filler words such as um, uh, like, you know, ah, er, basically, and actually are highlighted in yellow
- Repeated phrases are detected dynamically and highlighted in coral or orange
- A legend explains the highlight colors
- Users can copy the full transcription for review or use in another tool

6. Key Design Decisions & Tradeoffs

Decision	Rationale	Tradeoff
Post-recording transcription instead of real-time coaching	Simpler architecture and less distraction while speaking	Feedback is retrospective only
No community or social features	Keeps the app focused on the core problem and avoids unnecessary complexity	Users cannot compare themselves with others
Local topic data file instead of a database	Zero setup, easy to maintain, enough for prototype scale	Not suitable for user-generated topics without migration
Desktop-first but responsive	Better transcription review on larger screens while still usable on mobile browsers	Longer transcripts are still easier to read on desktop

7. Technical Stack

- Frontend: React + TypeScript with Vite
 - Routing: React Router
 - Styling: Tailwind CSS
 - UI components: Custom shaden-style components built on Radix primitives
 - Motion and animation: Motion
 - Speech-to-text: OpenAI Whisper API through a Vercel serverless function
 - Audio capture: Browser MediaRecorder API
 - Topic source: Local TypeScript data file
 - Hosting: Vercel
 - Version control: GitHub
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8. Potential Future Improvements

- Progress tracking to show session history and filler word reduction over time
 - Custom time limits such as 30 seconds, 2 minutes, or a user-defined duration
 - AI-generated feedback on pacing, clarity, and structure
 - User-submitted topics
 - Streaks or gamification for habit building
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9. Success Metrics

As a v1.0 portfolio project, success is defined by the following:

- The full flow works reliably: spin → record → transcribe → highlight
- Transcription is accurate enough to identify filler words in normal speech
- Filler words and repeated phrases are clearly distinguished in the UI
- The app is publicly accessible through a live URL

If productised later, useful metrics would include:

- Weekly active users
- Average sessions per user per week
- Self-reported improvement in filler word frequency over time